1. OSINT Fundamentals

1. What does OSINT stand for? Open-Source Intelligence: collecting and analyzing publicly available information.

2. What types of information are considered open-source? Public websites, social media, public records, news, DNS records, and company documents.

3. What are the five stages of the OSINT process? Planning, collection, processing, analysis, and reporting.

4. Why is verification important during an OSINT investigation? To ensure information is accurate, reliable, and up to date.

2. People and Company Reconnaissance

5. Why do analysts research organizations before conducting security assessments? To understand the organization's digital footprint and identify potential security risks.

6. What types of information can be found on a company's public website? Employee names, email addresses, technologies, services, contact details, and company structure.

7. Why should multiple public sources be compared? To cross-check information and reduce errors or false conclusions.

3. Domain and Infrastructure Reconnaissance

8. What information can WHOIS provide? Domain registration dates, registrar, nameservers, and sometimes registrant details.

9. What is the purpose of DNS? To translate domain names into IP addresses and provide other domain-related information.

10. Name three common DNS record types.

- A: Maps a domain to an IPv4 address.
- AAAA: Maps a domain to an IPv6 address.
- MX: Identifies mail servers.

11. What kind of information does Shodan index? Information about internet-connected devices, exposed services, open ports, and service banners.

4. Social Media and Metadata

12. What is metadata? Data that describes other data, such as a file's author, creation date, or location.

13. What information might be stored in an image's EXIF data? Camera model, date and time, camera settings, and sometimes GPS coordinates.

14. Why should organizations review documents before publishing them? To remove sensitive information, hidden metadata, and confidential details.

15. Why should information from social media be verified? Because it may be false, outdated, misleading, or taken out of context.

5. OSINT Tools

16. What is the purpose of theHarvester? To collect publicly available information such as email addresses, subdomains, and hostnames.

17. How does Maltego present information? As a visual graph showing relationships between people, domains, organizations, and other entities.

18. What is SpiderFoot used for? To automate OSINT collection and identify information about domains, IP addresses, emails, and digital footprints.

19. Why should OSINT tool results always be verified? Because results can be inaccurate, outdated, incomplete, or false positives.